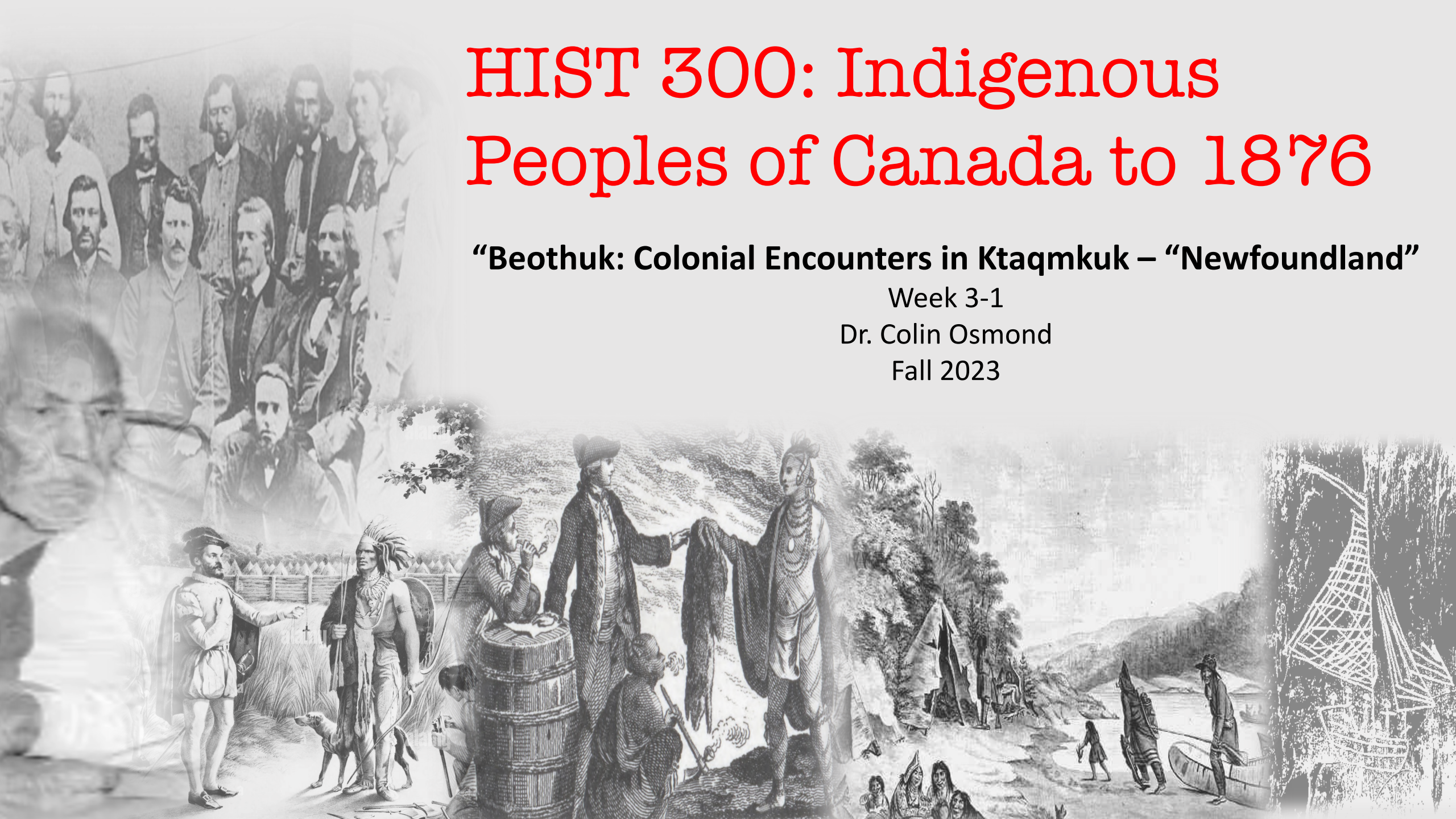
HIST 300: Indigenous Peoples of Canada to 1876

“Beothuk: Colonial Encounters in Ktaqmkuk – “Newfoundland”

Week 3-1

Dr. Colin Osmond

Fall 2023



Recap:

- Mi’kmaq were some of the first people in northern North America to contact non-Indigenous people
- Mostly short term interactions
- Columbian Exchange
  - Food, trade items, and germs
- Virgin Soil Epidemics
  - Mass mortality

Learning Outcomes/Keyword

- The Beothuk world – economic systems, resource extraction strategies
- Beothuk encounters with non-Indigenous people
  - Nordic explorers – L'anse Aux Meadows colony – 'Vinland'
  - Explorers and Fishers – temporary visitors
- Contact and Consequences
- Beothuk "extinction"?
  - Shanawdithit, the "last" Beothuk
- The settler obsession with the myth of terra nullius



“Drawing of a Beothuk Camp”, Major John Cartwright, D.U.

Norse Explorers

- “Viking” Explorers – around 1000 BCE
- Encounters with Beothuk documented in Norse “Sagas”
- “Vinland” – Wine Land
- L’Anse Aux Meadows
- “Skraelings”
- Short lived colony
- ~ 2-3 years

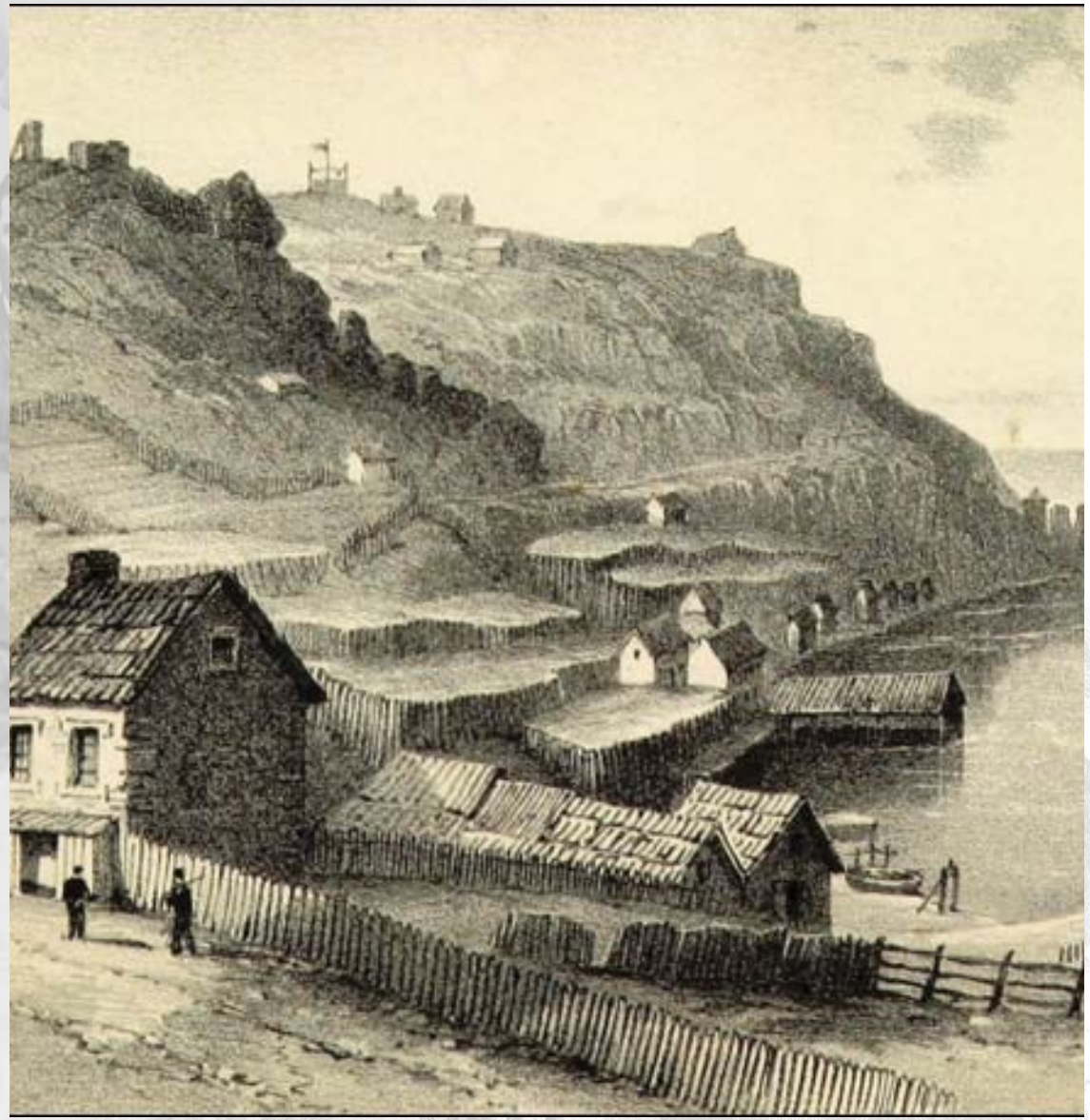


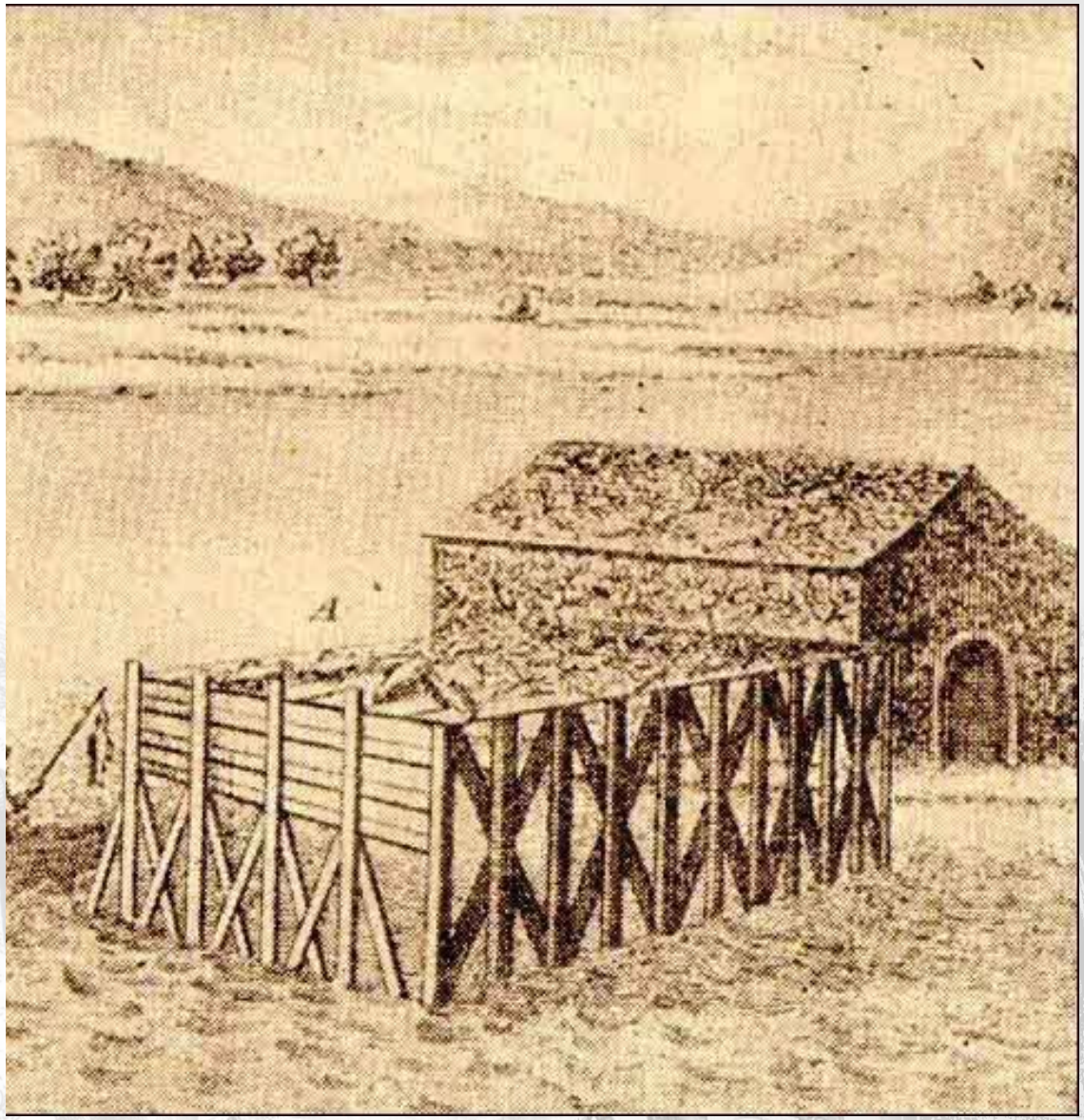




L’Anse Aux Meadows
UNESCO National Historic Site









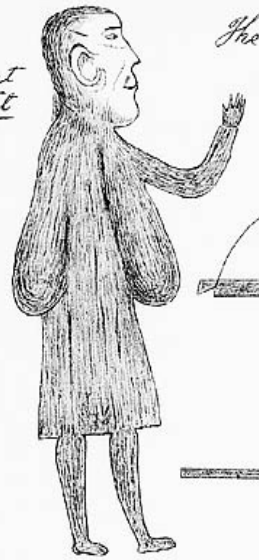
"Trading with the Beothuk in Trinity Bay, 1612" – a romanticized encounter by Theodor de Bry, 1628



Aich-mid-yim.

The Black man, or Red Indians Devil. short & very thick; He dresses in Beaver Skin, has a large beard &c.

Seen at the Great Lake



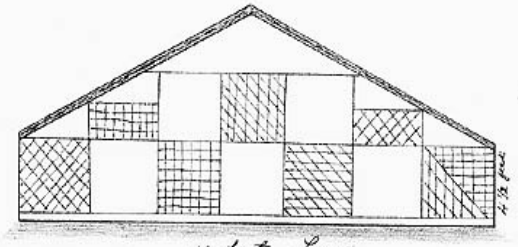
A-a-duth, or Spear for Killing Seals 12 feet long

Bone

Iron

Amina Deer Spear

Iron



10 feet Long

Store House in which they put their dried venison, in birch rind boxes or packages to keep during Winter

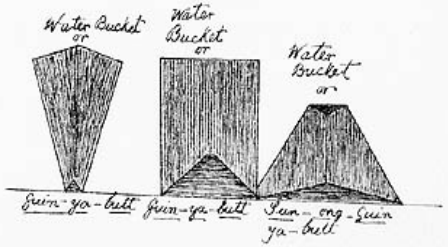
Dancing Woman



Thub-wed-gie.

Shoe-wan

Drinking cups or Shoe-wan-yeesh



Water Bucket or Quin-ya-bell

Water Bucket or Quin-ya-bell

Water Bucket or Quin-ong-Quin ya-bell


SCHOOL
BOOK
OVERLAND MAIL

Next Week:

Sept 21 - Indigenous Accommodation and Resistance in New France

- *Read: Daniel Richter, "War and Culture: The Iroquois Experience", 528-559.*
- *Belshaw: 46-49.*

